

Gratin Dauphinois à la Girardet

Proof that true luxury lies in simplicity. Potatoes, cream, garlic and a touch of nutmeg — nothing more. No cheese, no distractions. Just one of the most comforting and irresistible dishes ever created.

Ingredients

- 1.2 kg waxy potatoes (Charlotte or Ratte), peeled and very thinly sliced (2 mm)
- 600 ml double cream
- 2 cloves garlic, crushed
- Freshly grated nutmeg
- 30 g unsalted butter
- Salt and white pepper

Method

1. Preheat oven to 160°C (fan 140°C). Do not wash the sliced potatoes — the starch is essential.
2. Gently warm the cream with the crushed garlic, a generous grating of nutmeg, salt and white pepper. Do not boil. Remove garlic.
3. Rub a gratin dish generously with butter. Layer the potatoes evenly, seasoning lightly between each layer.
4. Pour the warm seasoned cream over the potatoes. It should just reach the top layer.
5. Dot the surface with the remaining butter.
6. Bake for 1 hour 30 minutes to 1 hour 45 minutes, until the top is deeply golden and the potatoes are completely tender when pierced.
7. Rest for 10 minutes before serving. The gratin should hold its shape but be soft and yielding throughout.